

Organizational Meeting Notes - January 11, 2021 - 5:45 PM

Mayor calls organizational meeting to order - 5:46 PM

Member Van der Kloot - takes roll call - 7-0 present - Salute the Flag

Mayor - Is there a motion on the floor for the Vice Chair position?

Member Kreatz - I make a motion and nominate Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member McLaughlin

Mayor - any other nominations?

Member Graham - Am I stating the name I am voting for?

Mayor - Yes

Votes- for Member Van der Kloot

Members Graham, Kreatz, Van der Kloot, Mustone, McLaughlin, Ruseau and the Mayor

Mayor - 7-0 - 2021 Vice Chair - Member Van der Kloot - Congratulations Paulette!

Member Van der Kloot - Member Ruseau will kindly be handling the public participation (emails) this evening for me.

Mayor - Is there a motion on the floor for the Secretary position?

Member Van der Kloot - I make a motion and nominate Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member Kreatz

Mayor - any other nominations?

Votes - for Member McLaughlin

Members Kreatz, Graham, McLaughlin, Mustone, Ruseau,
Van der Kloot and the Mayor

Mayor - 7-0 - 2021 Secretary- Member McLaughlin - Congratulations Melanie

Regular Meeting Notes - January 11, 2021

Mayor - Approval of December 21st School Committee Notes?

Motion for approval by Member Ruseau, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Member McLaughlin - calls the roll - 7-0 - minutes are approved

Member Ruseau - Member McLaughlin doesn't have the vote pad as yet?

Member McLaughlin - I am taking notes on my own and I am more than willing to pick up the pad sometime this week?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, no problem

Mayor - Approval of payrolls

Motion to approve by Member Kreatz, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call - 7-0 - Payrolls approved

Report of Secretary - Member Van der Kloot - I was signing the bills last Wednesday - a number of food service bills came through - I'd like to thank Gina Citrano and all other staff who has the bills in order for me to sign - very appreciative

Member McLaughlin - I would like to take this opportunity to thank Member Ruseau & Member Van der Kloot for their service last session

Mayor - Yes, thank you both very much

Mayor - Report of Committees - None

Mayor - Public Participation?

Member Ruseau - Email - Hello everyone, I hope this message finds you well in these strange times. I wrote last spring in support of the resolution to change the name of the Columbus Elementary School. I was surprised by the length of the debate, but pleased that the resolution ultimately passed. I understand that this issue is not anyone's top priority at the moment, but I also feel that you made a commitment to the community to make this change but have missed multiple deadlines. I would appreciate an update. Will there still be a committee to choose the

new name? Can we still expect the name change this summer? Kind regards, Sarah Florenz,
80 Marion St, Medford

Member McLaughlin - I make a motion to add to the Jan 25th agenda, seconded by Member Graham

Roll Call - 7-0 - motion passes

Member Ruseau - Email - Jane Hamel - 16 Maynard St, Medford, MA 02155 - As we all watch with horror at our increasing infections, I have been so grateful about the testing program at the schools. Thank you for making that happen. Is it possible to get information about participation rate and number of positives? I'm specifically interested in seeing:

- % of students per cohort per school who have submitted their paperwork (I did see 1700/2200 districtwide)
 - % of students who actually participated any given week at the high school (since it's up to them to remember to go, rather than the middle school where they get called to do it)
 - number of positive cases identified per cohort per school.

Is it possible to get this information before school starts on 1/14 and 1/20? And after that on an ongoing basis, such as every 2 weeks? It would help ease our family's concerns about heading back in during this surge.

Report of Superintendent - Happy New Year! It is my hope that 2021 will bring with it much happiness and good health for all in our Mustang family and the Medford community at large. However, the year didn't exactly begin very well. It started promising with the arrival of the vaccine. But, no matter what your political leaning, the events that transpired last Wednesday at the United States Capitol, was a horrendous show of the very worst of America. I am, as the majority of people in our country, a child of immigrants. My parents immigrated here from Haiti in the early 1960's. This type of action against the government does not happen here. For the first time ever, the confederate flag entered the United States Capitol, the seat of our government. Our democracy, which has always been the shining star in the world, was damaged. It was scary, unsettling and it once again shed light on both the fragility of our democracy, while also bringing to the forefront the inequality in our country. As our Vice President Elect Kamala Harris stated; "it is just one example of the blatant social inequity in the United States". The difference in the treatment of those protesting versus the military response to the mostly peaceful Black Lives Matter marches earlier this year was stark. Clearly, there are cracks in our democracy that need fixing. Additionally, we have known for generations, that much has to be done to create a more just, equitable, and unified society. The Medford Public Schools are committed to engaging in conversations that will promote understanding across lines of division. We will support our students and teach them to be leaders against hate, while working aggressively to address racist beliefs, practices, and systems. Next week would have been Dr.

King's 92nd birthday. As he said, "We must learn to live together as brothers or perish together as fools". I believe that it is imperative during this period of heightened stress and anxiety that we provide the structure and support that our children require right now. Unfortunately, we are currently facing a surge of COVID-19 cases in Medford. We are aware of this uptick and are working diligently to prepare for the safe return of hybrid staff and students when they come back to our buildings on January 14. We are continuing with our safety protocols to allow for this to happen. Testing will take place at each school building on the following dates and times in the usual testing locations within each school: On Tuesday, January 12th from 1pm - 5pm, we will test all MPS Staff and students in Cohorts A and C and on Friday, January 15th from 1pm - 5pm, we will test all students in Cohort B. For our incoming freshmen, testing can be accessed via the West Courtyard entrance. In addition, Freshman Orientation will be held in small, socially distanced groups for our 9th-grade students on January 13th. I just wanted to remind parents/guardians that students who qualify for free or reduced price meals under the National School Lunch Program, whether hybrid or fully remote, please know that P-EBT funds are available to you until the end of the 2020-2021 school year. For those who might have questions about this assistance, please contact the Department of Transitional Assistance at 877-382-2363

Last Friday, Mayor Lungo-Koehn, Principal D'Alleva, Dr. Ricciardelli and I had the pleasure of welcoming Mr. Adamo Castelnuevo, Director of the Consul General of Italy's Education Office to Medford High School. Mr. Castelnuevo presented the Mayor with a check in the amount of \$24,000 euros or \$29,447.00. As Dr. Ricciardelli reported to you at the last meeting, the funds will be used to defray the cost of the Advanced Placement Italian Program at the high school level for the 2020-2021 school year. Last month, Tufts University's Office of Community Relations hosted a Holiday Charity Raffle. Residents were asked via Tufts Facebook page to nominate a non-profit organization to win a \$500 prize. Congratulations to Marie Cassidy and her staff who have continued, despite Covid, to provide important services to our families, and thank you to Tufts University for providing this wonderful donation. Last Thursday, our DA Marian Ryan invited me to take part in a professional development training for incoming assistant district attorneys that focused on the effect of school discipline on black girls. Joining me on the panel was Melanie Rush from the Appleseed Center who discussed the study they completed highlighting the disproportionate impact of school discipline on black girls. I discussed the importance of inclusivity and equity here at the Medford Public Schools. It was wonderful to have been asked to participate in this important and substantial conversation with the young ADA's of Middlesex County. Just prior to our winter break, DA Ryan also hosted the first virtual "Cut it Out" program with the Vocational Cosmetology and Health Assisting students. We appreciate the continued collaboration we have with the District Attorney's Office.

Despite covid, CCSR members continue to find ways to improve our community. Nathan Quinn and Charlotte Foti, 6th graders at the McGlynn, and Abigail Charlton a 6th grader at the Andrews, noticed that the majority of the little free libraries around the city featured books for an older audience. So they held a book drive for middle school aged students, collecting a remarkable 249 books. I would like to close with a quote from President Abraham Lincoln's first Inaugural Address given in 1861. "We are not enemies, but friends. We must not be enemies. Though passion may have strained, it must not break our bonds of affection." Let us all please remember that, united we stand, divided we fall.

Mayor - Thank you Madam Superintendent. Now we will receive updates from Toni Wray & MaryAnne O'Connor

Ms. Wray - We tested 900 coming out with (2) positive students - from December 23rd - January 10th - there were 79 positive school cases that were reported to the Dept of Education - 63 of those being students and 16 being staff. This is consistent with how the city is doing overall. Please - if you have any symptoms at all or just don't feel right, whether a student, teacher or staff, stay home and get tested at one of the Stop the Spread sites.

Ms. O'Connor - 720 cases in 20 days in Medford - we are in a surge - 5-17 years old - 77 cases - small percentage - mostly the cases are 20-30 year olds - school nurses have been great with contact tracing - not only MPS but private schools as well - Medford is in the Red - 5.5% positivity - we will probably be close to the same this week as well - we expected this - glad we are testing this week - Most of what we have seen in the community - is household spread - happy to announce 1st responder vaccinations - police, fire, EMS - on Thursday - happy to say all the school nurses are included - surveillance testing people are able to receive it as well - K-12 workers, teachers, etc - they are in the State's plan for phase II, behind the aged 75+ - and will work with Toni on that - we are at the mercy of the state for that.

Mr. Murphy - Testing over next couple of weeks - Commissioner Riley noted MPS has been upfront with our testing, thanks to Toni and MaryAnne - we are part of a webinar tomorrow with other districts to discuss our testing - we will do re entry testing tomorrow - 1-5 PM - for Cohorts A, C and MPS staff - Curtis Tufts has own schedule - Cohort B will do testing Friday - 1-5 PM - and then we'll continue with weekly testing Jan 19th - we anticipate pool testing to begin Jan 26th - that's our plan for now - we will communicate information out to staff and families - very little difference in testing - difference is in the follow up - reflex testing (if someone is deemed in a positive pool) will take place on Wednesdays & Saturdays - Regular Covid testing will

continue on Tuesdays & Fridays. - we still need to iron out the specifics for the Wednesday/Saturday testing and we will communicate that out. - we are looking to get to 100% on the consent forms

Member Ruseau - I know you are working on details of reflex testing - we are depending upon families to get retested on Wednesdays and Saturdays. I hope they'll follow up - if they don't go back for a reflex test are they allowed back in our buildings?

Mr. Murphy - No they will not be - But for Cohort A and the staff - it will be a concern - our desire is that we don't make this difficult for families

Ms. O'Connor - it is really important that everyone gets that follow up testing

Member Van der Kloot - How many people in one pool test?

Mr. Murphy - between 8-10 - as tech improves there could be more swabs in a vial

Ms. O'Connor - 10 is the max at this point

Member Graham - Pooling? Is there a way to pool siblings within a building?

Mr. Murphy - generally speaking - the efficiency cost other than doing the 8 swabs in a vial - with the rates high now - the time that would be lost to coordinate family members and not filling up the vials- it hasn't been shown that if a sibling has covid, another might not - there are some upsides -but probably not financially worth it to try to configure getting siblings in one test tube

Member Graham - MPS is not 100% for testing, correct?

Mr. Murphy - in the vicinity of 80% - but I'd like to get back to you with a more accurate percentage

Mayor - over 1700 have signed up -

Ms. Wray - 400 - 450 staff have signed up

Member Graham - Have there been discussions among districts to make it mandatory for in school attendance?

Mr. Murphy - it's been discussed but hard to impose during a school year - can't house all the students - conversation for this summer to see where we are with the virus - testing isn't something invasive - it's about a community responsibility to one another

Member Graham - I am hoping that everyone will participate in this program - we are very lucky - other districts have to be remote as they can't don't have testing ability

Mr. Murphy - Principals and teachers have tried to get out the importance to all members of the community

Member Graham - Cohort D families test this week?

Mr. Murphy - No - Ms. Wray worked out program with colleges to have the personnel to do the testing - without this partnership, the sustainability would be in question

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - thank you to the school committee for your support - DESE has noticed and will feature us as how the testing has enabled us to bring our students back into school - a tremendous feat - thank our to our Nursing Supervisor, Toni Wray, MaryAnne O'Connor & Mr. Murphy and staff - we have been able to bring our students with testing and following Safety, equity and consistency - thank you to the Mayor and our city for paying for the testing with Tufts - districts that can't remain open as just don't have this type of support

Mayor - Thank you for all of your hard work as well Dr. Edouard-Vincent. What are the logistics for this week testing? Could I get all my children tested in one place? Will the lines be socially distanced and/or outside?

Mr. Murphy - siblings can get tested at one school, if they are in multiple schools - please email your school nurse if this is going to happen - we are expecting lines early rather than at the end of the testing - testing areas will be moved towards the doors for easy access

Ms. Wray - middle and high school students should enter by themselves so as not to overcrowd the areas

Mr. Murphy - the efficiency of which each school does, moves the student testing quickly in and out - to avoid any major disruption of instruction time - Principals and Nurses have made this possible and we are grateful - Parents should stay in car for middle/high school

Member Mustone - anyway you could do a reverse call that grades 6-12 parents should wait in the car due to numbers in the building? Short notice I know ...

Mr. Murphy - Yes, no problem. We will do a robo call tomorrow AM

Member Ruseau - the public is grateful for the testing - What is the participation rate overall, and , % per school

Mr. Murphy - we aren't happy with 80% - we aren't boasting about it, as we feel it needs to be higher

Member McLaughlin - could that information be provided in the bi-monthly reporting?

Mr. Murphy - I'd like to see the email closely and then I can respond to it

Member McLaughlin - make a motion to put onto the Jan 25th agenda as a follow up - how it will be reported out? Seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call - 7-0 - motion passes

Member Ruseau - what about the families that decline the testing?

Mr. Murphy - the system works based on positive consent forms - if a parent says no test or doesn't respond - no vial label is produced

Ms. Wray - I have fielded some of the emails of parents who decline the testing. Often the parents just don't understand the process - they fear what is going to mean - the conversations are worthwhile between the nurses and parents who may say no

Member McLaughlin - I was interested in that data - please send in your consent form - I'm not hearing if its no, to let us know - what about families with disabilities - they might need additional support for the testing - for any families that might not be getting the message - is there anyway to aggregate the data - anyway the school committee can help get the word out - how are we making it clear to families that you respond Yes or No to the testing - so as a district we know

Mr. Murphy - we don't want to plant the idea to opt out - don't want to legitimize the option to opt out - I just don't want to put it out there that they can opt out - there is no sound basis to not participate in the testing

Member McLaughlin - is there a way to aggregate that data? - I appreciate Ms. Wray following up with those families who don't want to participate - just want to make sure we don't have any patterns - If there are patterns with EL or SPED - that could be brought up in the team meetings

Mr. Murphy - yes we can share it

Member Ruseau - email - My name is Leticia Rocha at 3620 Mystic Valley Pkwy. I have the following questions regarding the public health updates provided:

- How often will students and staff have access to testing?
 - Medford is at the high risk level, with 394 cases in just one week. School transmission occurred with Brooks teachers. I am aware that there are multiple measures being looked at, but what are the levels of these metrics that would trigger remote-only learning within a school or district-wide? How many weeks do we need to be in the "red" before action is taken by administrators?

Mr. Murphy - we had to close a school prior to vacation - but it was a number of variables that forced them into remote - there is no one variable - actions are taken as necessary - the readiness, community rates, and what's happening in the school itself - no one variable can be used to make this decision

Mayor - Thank you Ms. Wray, Ms. O'Connor and Mr. Murphy. And now a presentation on the Andrews Middle School

Principal Downs - Happy New Year - now more than ever be kind to each other - Madeline Duggar Andrews is first school to be discussed in the new year - during a pandemic - lots of positives at the Andrews - huge thank you's to: the custodians -who rearranged desks, the cafe, hung signs, etc - without them, we just couldn't open the schools the way we did - Nurse Hines and the nursing staff - keeping the protocols at the forefront - our Cohort A students made it a priority - our teachers and paras - have come to school on a daily basis - November we held a food drive to assist families - families donated winter coats and food - Member Mustone did her own drive - we were able to provide coats to MFN - thousands of food items to our food pantries - a special thanks to the families who provided Thanksgiving dinners to our families - In December we held the Secret Snowflake Program - which provided gifts for our families - Wegmans and Rotary assisted as well - Medford always steps up for their community - Thank you also to my clinical team

Dr. Steve Burnham - new assistant principal at the Andrews, from MHS - I am interested in introducing Restorative practices - how strongly a student rated their connection to the school - pilot program - I'd like to unite our 3 secondary schools in this practice

Principal Downs - Book Club will start soon - Fair isn't always Equal - restorative justice - thank my staff - who hit the ground running from day 1 - they make sure it all works - really stepped up and can't thank them enough to make hybrid work - in your packets, you have quotes from our parents - some of their suggestions and comments help us do things better

Member Van der Kloot - Thank you to the Principal. Downs & Dr. Burnham - looking forward to the restorative justice practice - you didn't include any negative comments though? What areas could you improve?

Principal Downs - most were positive - I wouldn't call them negative - kids are so happy to be back in school - I guess the parents wish their students could go back more often & to increase communication regarding grading/performance

Member Van der Kloot - I applaud the book club - Have there been any transportation issues?

Principal Downs - not a lot of bus issues - we changed a lot of the stops and for the most part it has been very smooth

Member McLaughlin - Thank you for the report and being so inclusive with SPED and the meetings we used to host there - How does the Andrews work with McGlynn?

Principal Downs - we talk everyday - we offer the same opportunities to all of our students - we will be starting our clubs up again - we share speakers - we are Team Medford and are committed to working together

Member McLaughlin - happy to hear and happy you are very inclusive to all students

Principal Downs - we encourage it

Mayor - Thank you both - Mr. Teixeira will present the EL update

Mr. Teixeira - Happy New Year - - May 20th ACCESS testing - we will work around the MCAS schedule - no remote option for testing - even those who are remote only - we will make arrangements for those students - waiting until April - people will be vaccinated so it could work better - EL Data Dashboard - we did take ACCESS in January - but data isn't up yet - 2019 is most recent data - I can compare Medford to Malden and Somerville for example - 2016-2017 - everyone took a dip as they changed the test - while Malden, Somerville and state has decreased, Medford has increased - we do know who didn't make progress in 2020 - and we can address & provide the support they might need, across all classes, not just EL classes - we hope to recap time we lost last year

Newcomer elementary update - Grade 1-4 at Columbus and 5 at McGlynn - it was the right decision to move forward with this year - Worked out very well - newcomer classrooms are in, and were like the leaders of the school since they had been in, since Sept - no vans are needed -

yellow school buses only - Sat program grant - that will begin on Jan 30th - we are hiring teachers to do this - targeting students level 1 & 2 and doing it at the high school - high school has a finite time to learn the English language, algebra I - Title 3 monies for field trips - NE Aquarium virtual for elementary, 1st week in Feb - PD in year 3 of co-teaching model - we have Cohort A, hybrid students and our remote students - shout out to the teachers - working very hard to make this all work - PD on Culturally REsponsive Teaching (Title 3 - purchased books) - story about a family immigrating to U.S. and how it will impact the student in the classroom - Blueprint for EL Student Success - I'm on the committee - it will benefit the district, not just the middle school level - our EL numbers are down - 450 students - we had 114 EL students who started with us this year - students move in and out - 197 new EL students last year - overall down by 40 students

Member Ruseau - I hope no one is recruiting you - you aren't leaving us ever!

Member McLaughlin - the co-teaching model sounds great

Mr. Teixiera - a shared responsibility - we are lucky we have a newcomer program here - we don't have to have one - challenging for content teachers - so the co-teaching helps to balance it out

Member McLaughlin - Would love to see this utilized for Special Ed - I love this model - I appreciate the teachers as I know it's more work for them

Mayor - Thank you Mr. Teixeira. Update on athletics

Dr. Cushing - thank you to AD Maloney & GBL - for still providing students with the opportunity to compete in sports during Covid.

Mr. Maloney - thank you to Ms. Perry for doing the GBL schedules - Feb to March will be the Winter season and feature Girls Gymnastics & Girls Hockey. Fall Sports season- March 1st - Apr 10th - Spring Sports season May 7th - July 3rd - confident that fall and spring sports which are basically outside can compete

Dr. Cushing - we are looking to allow one parent in the outdoor venues - will work with Toni Wray on this - working to bring middle school sports intramural - there is no appetite for that in the GBL

Member Van der Kloot - when I look at the schedule - going to July 3rd - seniors will have graduated - will they still be eligible to play?

Mr. Maloney - MIAA allowing it - trying to get all 3 seasons in - so it's the fairest way to do it

Member Van der Kloot - do you think the seniors would compete until July 3rd?

Mr. Maloney - Yes, I think they will - they know we are trying

Mayor - Middle School schedule?

Mr. Maloney - we could consolidate the middle school schedule once we get outside
Discussing basketball right now - so our hope is to get all middle school sports in on an
intramural basis

Mayor - thank you Dr. Cushing and Mr. Maloney - Madam Superintendent

Racial Equity Task Force - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - earlier today I met with our racial equity task
force and share the work we have been doing - and now more than ever - challenges as a nation -
exercises we participate in today - sharing different thoughts/perspectives - a gratifying
experience today of how we can all come together - Wanted to formally present this report to
you and will produce a press release later in the week - we are working very hard to improve our
district -

Member McLaughlin - please post the press release onto the website - can you include what role
each member on the task force has? It would be helpful for the community at large to know -
meetings take place twice a month - can a SC member join in?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes - we meet Mondays at 2:45 twice a month - we meet for 1 hour to 1
½ hours.

Member Graham - can you talk a little bit about the Equity Audit?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - a consultant already provided what pieces of data - we are on covid time
right now, so not a traditional school year - we are looking towards the next school year, but
looking at laying down a foundation - looking at discipline data - looking at different schools -
we don't have a date for the Equity Audit - but it is one thing the Task Force would like some
baseline data - another task is PD - looking at additional ways to supplement PD - on Jan 20th
Cultural Proficiency Workshop for all staff - also we will be providing a workshop from
Feb 23rd - Apr 27th - 10 hours of training for racial _____ *(didn't get proper name of
the training) The Medford Public School district is committed to this.

Member Graham - would the Equity Audit be conducted by an external party?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - yes

Member Ruseau - the Equity Audit should be included in our budget - should prioritize this - to support this work - urge you to think about the budget timeline - so we can include it

Mayor - Thank you for your important work

Member Ruseau - Adam (from the community) has his hand up

Adam - thank you for the task force - will this be to redo the curriculum for schools?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - no, rather it will be used as a supplement to the existing curriculum as we have to follow all of the state standards

Mayor - Old business? - None. Communications? - None

Mayor - New Business - Mass Partnership Initiative - by Member McLaughlin

Member McLaughlin - I thought it was a great idea for Medford - supplements and strengthens district systems for family engagement - only 3 districts will be chosen - application is due Jan 26th - could this happen? Could Medford make an application? Informational webinar tomorrow

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - the importance and power of communication and being intentional about translation services - this is a good opportunity - definitely competitive and I'll want to jump onto the webinar along with members of my team

Member McLaughlin - thank you

Member Graham - if we do decide to move forward - build a complete communication strategy - from an application perspective - Communication subcommittee - it would make us very attractive

Mayor - Thank you to Member McLaughlin and Dr. Edouard-Vincent. Please provide us with an update before the 26th so we know the process

Member Van der Kloot - Thank you Member McLaughlin - the information you sent today, did it have the webinar info in it?

Member McLaughlin - yes

Member Ruseau - contract negotiations? Do we have a schedule?

Mr. Murphy - Due to conditions we are operating under we have been in frequent communication with the teacher union leadership - time is approaching soon - we have received only 3 of the 11 bargaining units so far asking us to begin negotiations -

Mayor - Condolences to the families of James Malone, Joseph Ferrari, Patricia Misuraca, Michael Sueltenfuss, Osama Bianchi, and Peter L. Brady

Motion to adjourn by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Meeting is adjourned - 8:17 PM